



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

ātmā-eva hy ātmanaḥ sākṣī gatiḥ ātmā tathā-ātmanaḥ | 8.84a

mā-avamaṁsthāḥ svam ātmānaṁ nṛṇāṁ sākṣiṇam uttamam || 84 || 8.84c

manyante vai pāpakṛto na kaś cit paśyati-iti naḥ | 8.85a

tāṁs tu devāḥ prapaśyanti svasya-eva-antarapūruṣaḥ || 85 || 8.85c

— Manusmṛti, 8.1.4.3. Questioning of Witnesses (Chapter 3), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

Within these verses of the Manusmṛti lies a powerful reminder of the ever-present witness within you. The text asserts that your own soul is the ultimate witness, the very path and destination of your being. It urges you not to underestimate the immense power and integrity of this inner self, for it serves as the most superior judge of all your actions. This isn't about some external deity constantly scrutinizing you, but rather the inherent moral compass residing deep within your own consciousness.

The verses address the misconception that wrongdoers harbor, the belief that their transgressions go unnoticed. People may think their misdeeds are hidden, that no one is watching. However, the Manusmṛti clarifies that the divine, or more accurately, the inner self, is always observing. This "inner person," as it's described, is akin to your conscience, your intuition, the part of you that knows right from wrong regardless of external pressures or justifications. It's the silent observer residing within, constantly aware of your true intentions and actions.

In modern life, this wisdom is incredibly relevant. We live in a world where appearances often matter more than substance, where it's easy to get caught up in presenting a curated image to the world. Social media, with its emphasis on likes and validation, can tempt you to prioritize external approval over internal integrity. This passage reminds you to cultivate your inner awareness, to listen to that quiet voice within that guides you towards truth and righteousness. It's a call to self-accountability, urging you to act in accordance with your highest values, even when no one else is watching. It emphasizes that true integrity comes from aligning your actions with your inner compass, rather than seeking external validation. This passage encourages you to live a life of authenticity, knowing that your true self is always aware, always guiding you towards the path of dharma.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

In what areas of your life are you tempted to compromise your integrity, and how can you strengthen your connection to your inner witness to guide you towards more virtuous choices?